

LSLC Newsletter - September / October 2023

Living Savior Lutheran Church <secretary@livingsaviorlutheran.org>

Sat 9/2/2023 7:39 AM

To:Cathi Willuweit <rcwilluweit@hotmail.com>

Living Savior Lutheran Church

Newsletter -September / October 2023



Pastor's Message

Labor pains! I've never had true labor pains, but my wife assures me that they are painful. I'll take her word for it. The Apostle Paul uses the illustration of Labor pains to describe what is going on in our souls. "We know that the whole creation has been groaning as in the pains of childbirth right up to the present time. [23] Not only so, but we ourselves, who have the firstfruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly as we wait eagerly for our adoption as sons, the redemption of our bodies." [Romans 8:22-23] In this world, and in each of us, there is much groaning and sighing going on. Paul is being brutally honest about life. Perhaps there is some pain or hurt

that is just too painful for words. All we can do is groan or sigh.

I have often had people tell me that they wish they could help someone who was hurting, but “I just did not know what to say.” Sometimes we just cannot find the right words to say to someone. This is also true for our prayers. Later in verse 26 Paul states: “In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. We do not know what we ought to pray for, but the Spirit himself intercedes for us with groans that words cannot express.” [Romans 8:26] When we turn towards God to ask for help, direction, guidance, we do not always know how to pray! Sometimes before the throne of God we are speechless.

The good news is that the Holy Spirit speaks up for us. The Holy Spirit helps us, intercedes for us, better than we could intercede for ourselves. The Holy Spirit intercedes with sighs too deep for words, and says what we wish we could say.

God does not call us to be eloquent at prayer. There are times when what we need to express before Him is beyond our capability. My grandfather spoke Slovak. His English was limited to a few words. Obviously, it made it difficult to communicate with him when I was a child. As loving and caring as a grandfather could be, he just could not communicate with me. However, when my father was present, he would translate for us. And that made all the difference! “... The Spirit helps us in our weakness. We do not know what we ought to pray for, but the Spirit himself intercedes for us with groans that words cannot express.”

God’s peace this month,

Reverend Andrew C. Lissy



President's Message

As the season changes from summer to fall, the slower laid-back pace of summer gives way to a busier, more active schedule in the fall.

The same is true for Living Savior Lutheran Church. In September, we hold our annual **Rally Day event** where we celebrate the re-start of the church's fall activities which took a break for the summer.

Pre-school classes/activities will once again start up, Sunday School, Confirmation, and Bible Study classes will start up, and our church choirs, Chancel Choir and Modern Worship Ensemble, will once again begin rehearsals and singing in our church services.

Rally Day is also an opportunity for us church members to re-examine how we might serve Our Lord in the coming year with our gifts of time, talent, and treasures. This year Rally Day will be on Saturday September 9 from 4:00 pm - 6:00 pm in Klein Hall. We will have a church pot luck as part of the event and our ministry leaders will have tables around Klein Hall with information about their specific ministry. If you would like information about a particular ministry area or would like to serve in a particular ministry area, this is your opportunity to talk to church ministry leads and find out what they do and what you can to serve in that ministry.

In closing, I would like to thank all our church leaders, both past and present, for their dedicated service and leadership to Our Lord and to Living Savior. Thank you to all those members who volunteer to help out in whatever ways they are able with our many church activities and programs. In particular, I would like to thank our 2023-2024 ministry leads and our Board of Servant Leaders and church group coordinators, who are listed below, for stepping up and offering their time and talent and service to Living Savior Lutheran Church each day. If you have opportunity, please share with them your appreciation to them and tell these leaders thank you for their time and talent and service.

Al Gray, our Congregational Vice-President

Barbara Cloutier, our Congregation's Recording Secretary

Andrew Hartlage, our Church Treasurer

Tyna Gaylor, our assistant Church Treasurer

Aasgeir Gangsaas, our Church Financial Secretary

Cari Pao, Alan Waite, Tracy Price, and Vanessa Solt, our church's BoSL

At-Large Members

Habtu Mesfen, our Communications lead and George Mason University Liaison

Robert Urps, our Education Ministry Lead

Tracie Sluder, our Fellowship Ministry Lead

Ric Weyrick and Bob Willuweit, our Outreach Ministry Co-Leads

Steve Galing, our Property Ministry Lead.

Steve Thomas, our Social Ministry Lead. Steve is also looking for a co-lead if you are interested.

Chuck Froemke, our Stewardship Lead

Dr. Wallace Horton, our Worship Ministry Lead

Ben and Ellena Pollock, our Youth Group Ministry Co-Leads

Cathi Willuweit, our Living Savior Newsletter editor

Pam Belch, Altar Guild

Kevin Flom, Security Ushers

Leon Debolt

President, Living Savior Lutheran Church



Vicar Stephen Wareham
September/ October 2023

Gods' blessings be with you all as we enter into another September, for many families yet another new year of school. This time of the year always makes me think of new beginnings, even more so than January and New Year's Day. See, being in my seventh year of college, this is always when I have to return to school. I've moved from one place to another far too often at this time of year, including this year.

September is also the month I graduated from Marine Corps Boot Camp and the month my son was born. It seems to be consistently a time of change in my life. And with that comes a feeling of both excitement and trepidation, anticipation and anxiety, joy and fear. When change happens, we're never sure what to expect.

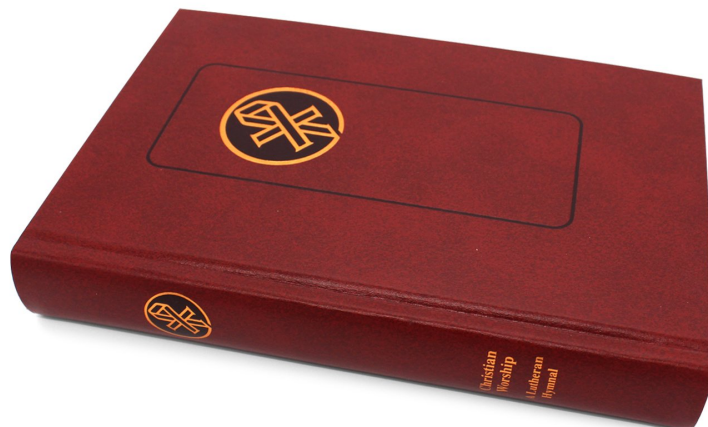
But the Lord promises us in Psalm 121:8 that He, "Will keep your going out and your coming in from this time forth and forevermore." No matter what changes come, no matter how big or how small, how joyous or how terrible, our God is with us and His protection is over us. We are never left alone, bereft of His guidance and having to navigate life's constant changes on our own. This has become clear to me over a lifetime of changes, that the one constant through them all has been God and His love and protection, just as it has been for all of us.

But, as usual, this is not all God offers us! In Jeremiah 29:11, He tells us that He has, "plans to prosper you... plans to give you hope and a future." We not only have God's protection and guidance and love, we also have the knowledge that God has His plan and purpose for us that will not fail. We may not know what to expect when changes happen, but God does, and He will lead us through it all under His divine protection! I can see this in my own life, as God as has lead me to a truly welcoming and caring vicarage here at Living Savior Lutheran Church.

So as we enter into another year of new beginnings, rest confidently in the Words of God, trusting that His protection is always over us and that His plan for us never fails.

God's Blessings,

Vicar Stephen Wareham



Music and Worship Notes

September / October 2023

CHANCEL CHOIR

The Chancel Choir will resume rehearsals on Wednesday, September 6 at 7:30 in the Sanctuary. Membership is open to those who are High School age and older. The ability to read music is helpful, but not required. The Chancel Choir sings at both 8:30 and 11:00 service on various Sundays approximately two to three times a month. For further information please speak with Dr. Horton.

MODERN WORSHIP ENSEMBLE

The Modern Worship Ensemble will resume rehearsals on Tuesday, September 12 at 7:30 in the Sanctuary. This group provides music and worship leadership at one 11:00am service each month, October through June. For further information please speak with Candie Jefferson or Dr. Horton

WORSHIP SETTINGS IN SEPTEMBER

Beginning September 3, we will use the order of Matins (*LSB pp. 219 ff.*) at the 8:30 services on the 2nd and 4th Sundays of the months and Settings 2 of the liturgy (*LSB pp 167 ff.*) at all other Sunday morning services. Matins in a non-communion service that can trace its history as far back as the 3rd c. It was included in the LCMS's previous hymnals (*The Lutheran Hymnal 1941* and *Lutheran Worship 1982.*) Setting 2 of the communion liturgy, as well as Setting 1 were written for *Lutheran Book of Worship (1978)* and *Lutheran Worship (1982)*. Both settings were included as well in our most recent hymnal. *Lutheran Service Book 2006.*

Dr. Wallace Horton
Minister of Worship and Music



Stewardship Update

I'd like to offer a stewardship moment and personally thank and recognize Sid Heetland for his many, many years of selfless stewardship towards Living Savior Lutheran Church. If you look up the definition of stewardship, you'll see Sid's name in the definition. During my time as BOSL president, I got to see first-hand the countless hours he spent as the assistant treasurer, handyman, HR manager, payroll/finance manager, business analyst, and choir member as

well as the many other roles he filled to keep our church working well. When the church faced problems, Sid would always come up with a solution, saving us all time and money. One example I'd like to share is when our perimeter wood fence started sagging and falling apart and after the local home owner's association approached us, he staved off a \$25K fence replacement expense and instead installed horizontal stabilizing boards for \$500; buying us another 10 years. Sid always stepped up and provided on-going stewardship wherever the need. Living Savior wishes Sid the very best as he moves to Richmond to begin his new journey in life. Thank you, Sid!

In case you were not aware, August was the National Make-A-Will Month. While everyone needs a will, about 30% of Americans say they actually have one. A will is a chance to protect loved ones by naming a guardian for minor children and an opportunity to take control of an uncertain future by making financial and real estate plans now, instead of leaving it up to the courts later to decide. Part of creating a will is to formalize estate planning and your wishes on support to charities and other important causes that are important to you and your family such as long-term support to the Living Savior Endowment Fund.

You will have an opportunity to make your time, talent and treasure intentions known including estate planning as part of the broader effort to collect your stewardship commitments for the 2023-24 church year. On October 22, 2023, Living Savior will collect your stewardship commitment forms, which help to create budgets and fill the various ministry positions that support His mission. Look for the stewardship commitment forms attached to the bulletins in October and in an email that will go out before stewardship commitment Sunday. After the forms are collected during each service that day, the forms will be given to the financial secretary, where your financial commitment will be noted and remain confidential. The time and talent service commitment portion of the form will be shared with ministry leads. Please take the time and reflect on your personal gifts and talents that enable your stewardship, your walk with Christ, and your commitment to grow your own faith. Living Savior provides you with an opportunity to challenge yourself again this church year and completing the stewardship commitment form is an excellent way to invest in your overall spiritual growth and wellbeing. Please return your stewardship commitment form on October 22nd and let's make this another strong personal growth year.

Bible Studies and Groups at Living Savior Lutheran Church

Children's Sunday School is on summer break. In the fall we welcome all school age children to a fun-filled time learning about Jesus. The unit this fall focuses on Jesus' birth, growing up, and many of his miracles. Primary class is for PreK-Grade 1. Upper



elementary is for Grades 2-5. We will meet between services from 10:00 to 10:45 in the Preschool wing. Please email to register your children. Jean-[Marie Galing](#)



Adult Sunday Adult Bible Study

Adult Sunday school will be restarting on September 10th in Klein Hall in between services. Bubba Urps is

planning a fall study on how to interact with our neighbors to share God's love and plan for salvation.

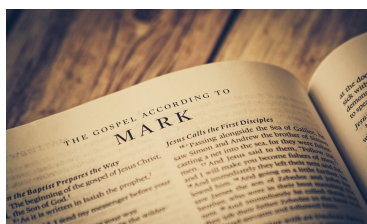


Confirmation Class Between Service Sundays. Contact Pastor Andy or Vicar Stephen .

Women's Bible Study

Women's Bible Studies will be on summer break. Look back here in the Fall for more information

Men's Bible Studies



Living Savior Men's Fellowship Study Breakfast All men of the congregation are invited to join other Living Savior men for breakfast, prayer and study on the 2nd and 4th Saturday of each month from 7:30 – 9:00 am. For

those who cannot attend the breakfast in-person, we have Zoom available for the prayer and discussion. For our current study starting in September, we will be discussing the Gospel of Mark. Questions or Zoom information? Contact Paul Gross at Paul.grossjr@verizon.net



Men's Christian Fellowship Dinner -
4th Thursday of the month at 6pm in Klein Hall



Youth Group

This past summer four of our Youth had the opportunity to participate in the Servant Event Week at Camp Linn Haven in the mountains of North Carolina. They spent the week serving people in a very needy community and making new friends with other Lutherans from across the mid-Atlantic.

Now, we have kicked off and look forward to a great year ahead! Upcoming Youth events:

Sun, Sept 17 4-6pm Meeting

Sun, Oct 1 1-4pm Fun Event with Other churches (TBD)

Sat, Oct 14 8:30-12am Pre-school Fall Festival support

Sun, Oct 22 4-6pm Meeting

Sun, Nov 6 1:30-4pm CROP Walk

Sun, Nov 19 4-6pm Meeting

For more information, please contact Ben or Ellena Pollock benellena@gmail.com

Events Happening at LSLC

Rally Day

Saturday, September 9th 4:00-6:00pm

Rally Day 2023

Rally Day is also an opportunity for us church members to re-examine how we might serve Our Lord in the coming year with our gifts of time, talent, and treasures. This year Rally Day will be on Saturday September 9 from 4:00 pm - 6:00 pm in Klein Hall. We will have a church pot luck as part of the event and our ministry leaders will have tables around Klein Hall with information about their specific ministry. If you would like information about a particular ministry area or would like to serve in a particular ministry area, this is your opportunity to talk to church ministry leads and find out what they do and what you can to serve in that ministry.

Please click the link below to sign up!!

<https://www.signupgenius.com/go/4090A48A5A62B0-living>



Family Game Night 1st Fridays of the Month Friday, October 6th

4:00pm - 8pm

Please join us on Friday evening, in Klein Hall for family fun from 4:00pm to 8pm. If you are interested in helping or finding out more information, please contact Tracie Sluder

Men's Retreat

The annual Men's Retreat will be held **15-17 September** at the Roslyn Retreat Center, 8727 River Road, Richmond, VA. We are thrilled to have Pastor Alec Fisher, our second vicar 2014-2015, as our facilitator. As the date approaches, he'll announce the topic. He is currently the Senior Pastor at Christ Lutheran Church, Hickory, NC.

If you are interested in attending, please tell Ric, Paul, or Steve.

Octoberfest!!

Friday, October 13
7:00pm



Join us for fun and food to celebrate the fall.
More information to follow about this traditional Fellowship event. For more information see Tracie Sluder.

Mark your calendars

Family Game Night - November 3rd
LSLC Voter's Meeting - November 12th
Cathedral Brass Band - December 2nd

SOCIAL MINISTRY

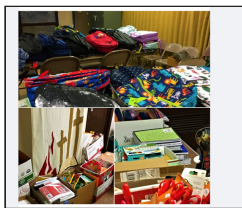
September / October 2023

**We are still waiting for the person
God has chosen to help co-lead
Social Ministry. If you are interested
please contact Steve or Bonnie
Thomas.**

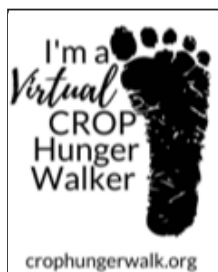
Get Ready, Get Set, Completed Projects



Maui Wildfire Relief - The LCMS is collecting funds to assist Emmanuel Lutheran Church, Kahului, Maui. This church maintained a preaching station in Lahaina that was destroyed and has member families that were directly affected. They are also trying to assist those who have lost everything in the recent fire. Please consider donating to this disaster relief fund. Living Savior will be collecting funds for the next three weeks. Please contribute with a check earmarked for "Maui Relief." Thank you.



Backpacks!! Thank you! We are still in awe of the magnificent effort on the part of all at Living Savior. Please know what a blessing your efforts are to the children in need in our community. Such lovely backpacks and quality supplies are appreciated more than you know. We know it is all from God's hand. You and our brothers and sisters in Christ are truly His hands and feet.



Crop Walk will be happening again this year on Sunday, November 6th. Join the walk or donate to benefit the hungry. For more information see Steve Gayling.

Concordia Lutheran Food Ministry
*Be Part of the Body Which
Brings the Bread of Life to Your
Friends and Neighbors!*

Visit us at “The Ark,” a modular unit behind
the church.

Outreach

- **What's happening sheet** – If you want to see what is happening in Sept / October go to the [LSLC website](#) under Announcements to download the LSLC Outreach Information Sheet. Good to pass on to neighbors, family or friends who may be looking to get involved in the LSLC activities.
- **Greeters** – If you are interested in becoming a greeter at services, please contact Ric Weyrick [or Bob Willuweit](#)

Opportunities to Serve

- **USHERS!!! We NEED USHERS** – Since many of the congregation are safe-at-home, we need those who can help as Ushers. For Sunday 8:30 or 11am service Ushers, see Pastor Andy since he will be looking for volunteers for the upcoming months soon.
- **Altar Guild** - Please consider helping with altar guild duties. Teams are on a rotating schedule. Within each team, members decide how they will execute the month's responsibilities so that the schedule is convenient. Free training! Flexible schedule! Many hands make light work! If you would like additional information, please contact Pam Belch: pcbelch@comcast.net
- **Lay Crucifiers** - we have returned to using lay crucifiers at both in-person worship services. All lay people (men and women) middle-school age and older are welcome to service as crucifiers. All must complete a short training course prior to serving. To volunteer / schedule your training session. Please contact Dr. Horton

- **Chancel Choir** - The Chancel Choir resumed rehearsals on Wednesdays, 7:30pm in the sanctuary. Membership is open to singers high school age or older. The ability to read music is helpful but not required. If you are interested in being a member, please contact Dr. Horton.
- **Modern Worship Ensemble** - The Modern Worship Ensemble rehearses on Tuesdays at 7:30. If you are interested in participating, please contact Candie Jefferson
- **Lay Readers** - If you are a trained Lay Reader and would like to read in the upcoming months, please see Dr. Horton to select a date(s) to read. If you have not received training to be a Lay reader but would like to become a Lay Reader, please see Dr. Horton so that you can receive training.
- **Live Streaming operators** - Help get the digital message out to those watching live steam worship. We are especially encouraging teens who have digital skills. Contact Pastor Andy
- **Coffee and Donut/Bagels** - We are looking for volunteers to make coffee on Sunday mornings! This is a very important way to make visitors feel welcome and encourage fellowship among the Living Savior family! Please click the link to sign up! <https://www.signupgenius.com/go/4090A48A5A62B0-sunday>



Living Savior Preschool News

**Living Savior Preschool
starts up for the 2023-2024
school year!**

Preschool enters its 32nd year!!! We held our Open House on Wednesday, August 30th and on Tuesday and Wednesday, September 5th and 6th we will start classes. Our hours are from 9:15 to 1:15 for all classes. We also offer Stay 'N Play (SNP), which is our after-school program, every day from 1:15-2:10 p.m. The past few weeks have been a busy and exciting time for LSP. We cleaned and set up our classrooms in preparation for the new school year. We are excited about the prospect of beginning a new school year with all of the children and their families as we continue to enhance our program for the 2023-2024 school year. We are also blessed to have such a dedicated and wonderful Christian staff to work with again this year.

September will be busy at LSP. Our Parent Orientation will be held on the first Wednesday in September. Later in the month the children, their families and the LSP staff will gather for the Annual Preschool Potluck Dinner. This year the potluck dinner is scheduled for Wednesday, September 27th. It is a wonderful opportunity for families to gather for the first time and enjoy some fellowship. We will have a full house for sure as all our classes gather for dinner on that night! It will be an exciting start to the school year!

We will kick off our school year with our annual Midland Fundraiser. We would love to invite the church and school community to support our fundraisers this year! We are raising money to enrich our curriculum cart and update puzzles in the classrooms.

In October, we will host our annual Fall Festival outside for preschool families on October 14 from 10-noon. It's always a happy occasion for families to spend some time outside getting some fresh air and enjoying time together. Later in the month, the Firefighters will visit the preschool to teach the children about fire safety. Also, we have our Costume Parade at the end of October in Klein Hall for families to enjoy some fall songs that the children will be learning.

If you know of any families who are looking for a warm, positive, Christian preschool experience, we have a couple spaces still available in each class. We would be happy to answer any questions they may have about our school. We can be reached at 703-352-4208 to set up a tour or by email at preschoo@livingsaviorlutheran.org. We look forward to another great year with all of the children and their families!

Opportunities to Worship

- **Sundays 8:30am**, Traditional Worship, Holy Communion 1st and 3rd Sundays
- **Sundays 11:00am**, Traditional Worship when not Modern Worship, Holy Communion 2nd and 4th Sundays. Modern Worship on October 8th
- **Online Worship Opportunities** – Sunday 11:00am service live-streamed and available for later viewing, see LSLC website for details.

Find Out More at LSLC

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